

Benjamin A. Jasperson, Ph.D., P.E.

Postdoctoral Scholar - Research Associate
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Pronouns: he/him/his

EDUCATION

- 2024 **University of Illinois Urbana - Champaign**, Urbana, IL
Ph.D. in Theoretical and Applied Mechanics
NSF NRT Trainee (*DIGI-MAT*) w/ Graduate Concentration in Data Science & Engineering
Dept. of Mechanical Science & Engineering
Advisor: Harley T. Johnson, Ph.D.
Towards Data-Driven Inverse Design for Materials and Structures
- 2010 **University of Wisconsin - Madison**, Madison, WI
M.S. in Mechanical Engineering
Dept. of Mechanical Engineering
Advisors: Frank Pfeifferkorn, Ph.D., and Kevin Turner, Ph.D.
Development and Calibration of Microscale Heat Flux Sensors Fabricated on Bulk Copper Substrates
- 2008 **University of Wisconsin - Madison**, Madison, WI
B.S. in Mechanical Engineering
w/ Certificate in Business
Dept. of Mechanical Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2024 - Postdoctoral Scholar - Research Associate
Prof. Krishna Garikipati's group
University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA
- 2017 - 2020 Mechanical Engineer, Phoenix Nuclear Labs, Madison, WI
Focused on the design and production of high-yield fusion neutron sources for the medicine, defense, and energy sectors. Now a part of SHINE Technologies.
- 2010 - 2017 Senior Mechanical Design Engineer, Plexus Corp., Neenah, WI
Concept, design, verification, and manufacturing transfer for devices in healthcare, industrial, defense/aerospace, and telecom.

PUBLICATIONS

See *Google Scholar* for a research impact summary.

Journal Articles (Peer-Reviewed)

- 2026 M. F. Shojaei*, R. Gulati*, **B. A. Jasperson***, S. Wang, S. Cimolato, D. Cao, M. Vardhan, W. Neiswanger, and K. Garikipati, "AI University: An LLM-Based Learning Assistant Aligned with Course-Specific Content in the Finite Element Method," under review, *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*, <https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.08846>, 2025. (* Equal Contribution)
- 2025 **B. A. Jasperson**, I. Nikiforov, B. Runnels, H. T. Johnson, and E. B. Tadmor, "Fundamental microscopic properties as predictors of large-scale quantities of interest: Validation through grain boundary energy trends," *Acta Materialia*, p. 120722, Jan. 2025.

- 2025 **B. A. Jasperson**, I. Nikiforov, A. Samanta, F. Zhou, E. B. Tadmor, V. Lordi, and V. V. Bulatov, “Cross-scale covariance for material property prediction,” *npj Computational Materials*, vol. 11, no. 1, p. 1, Jan. 2025.
- 2024 **B. A. Jasperson** and H. T. Johnson, “A data-driven method for optimization of classical interatomic potentials,” *MRS Advances*, vol. 9, no. 11, pp. 863–869, Mar. 2024
- 2024 **B. A. Jasperson**, M. G. Wood, and H. T. Johnson, “A dual neural network approach to topology optimization for thermal-electromagnetic device design,” *Computer-Aided Design*, vol. 168, p. 103665, Mar. 2024
- 2014 **B. A. Jasperson**, J. Schmale, W. Qu, F. E. Pfefferkorn, and K. T. Turner, “Thin film heat flux sensors fabricated on copper substrates for thermal measurements in microfluidic environments,” *J. Micromech. Microeng.*, vol. 24, no. 12, p. 125018, Dec. 2014.
- 2010 **B. A. Jasperson**, Yongho Jeon, K. T. Turner, F. E. Pfefferkorn, and Weilin Qu, “Comparison of micro-pin-fin and microchannel heat sinks considering thermal-hydraulic performance and manufacturability,” *IEEE Trans. Comp. Packag. Technol.*, vol. 33, no. 1, pp. 148–160, Mar. 2010.

Conference Proceedings

- 2021 M. Wood, A. McKay, T. Morin, D. Serkland, T. Luk, S. Wolfley, L. Gastian, J., **B. A. Jasperson**, and H. T. Johnson, “Optically-triggered optical limiters for short-wavelength infrared sensor protection,” presented at CLEO, virtual, STh1E.3, 2021
- 2010 **B. A. Jasperson**, F. E. Pfefferkorn, W. Qu, and K. T. Turner, “A thin-film heat flux sensor fabricated on copper for heat transfer measurements in parallel channel heat sinks,” in *Proceedings of the 5th International Conference on Micromanufacturing*, p 437-444, 2010.
- 2009 C. Konishi, W. Qu, **B. A. Jasperson**, F. Pfefferkorn, and K. T. Turner, “Experimental study of adiabatic water liquid-vapor two-phase pressure drop across an array of staggered micro-pin-fins,” *ASME International Mechanical Engineering Congress and Exposition Proceedings*, v10, p 1597-1605, 2009. (Peer-Reviewed)

Manuscripts in Preparation

- 2026 **B. A. Jasperson**, Q. T. Tran, I. D. Boureima, H. Mourad, and K. Garikipati, “A global-local approach to phase-field fracture mechanics using an integrated machine learning-PDE solver”
- 2026 I. Nikiforov, D. Karls, C. Waters, E. Fuemmeler, **B. A. Jasperson**, K. Sheriff, J. E. Ogbebor, R. Freitas, G. Zhang, P. Hoellmer, T. Egg, S. Martiniani, R. Elliott, N. Bernstein, Cyberloop Personnel, AFLOW Personnel, and E. B. Tadmor, “Crystal Genome: OpenKIM interatomic potential testing framework for arbitrary AFLOW crystal prototypes”
- 2026 R. Gulati, **B. A. Jasperson**, J. Zhang, O. Liu, M. Vardhan, D. Cao, W. Neiswanger, and K. Garikipati, “Benchmarking spatiotemporal foundation models for accuracy and stability of physics forecasting”

PATENTS

- 2019 P. Anderson, K. Novak, K. McLennan, M. Mackaplow, G. Song, G. S. Dhami, **B. Jasperson**, S. Smieja, M. Svacina, “Devices and methods for delivering a beneficial agent to a user,” 10213546, Feb. 26, 2019.

RESEARCH SUPPORT & RESOURCE ALLOCATIONS

Active / Awarded

- 2026 Allocation Manager & Lead Renewal Author, ACCESS (MCH240079)
Project: “Learning Mechanics-Driven Multiphysics Phenomena Using Generative AI on Spatiotemporal Simulation Data”
Allocation: 1.5M ACCESS Credits (~28K GPU-hours)
- 2026 External Collaborator (PI: Lampros Svolos), UVM Scholarship of Teaching and Learning
Project: “Teaching-Aligned AI Learning and Rubric-Guided Feedback in Engr. Mechanics”
Total Amount: \$8,500

Pending / Under Review

- 2026 Co-PI, U.S. Department of Energy (DOE BES)
Funding call: The Genesis Mission: Transforming Science and Energy with AI
Project: “Bridging Scientific Models and Hybrid Quantum-Classical Workflows through AI-Driven Unitary Composition”
Status: Submitted April 2026, Total Requested: \$750,000
- 2026 Co-PI, ASCR Leadership Computing Challenge (ALCC, Proposal Number 6000090)
Project: “Microstructure Insights through Reliable/Interpretable AI and Guided Experiments”
Allocation: 964.5K node-hours (Aurora and Frontier)
Status: Submitted Jan 2026, Under Review

INVITED TALKS

- 2026 B. Jasperson, L. Dehay, J. Tan, S. Siddhartha, K. Garikipati, “Modeling of agent interactions in a complex landscape,” Society of Engineering Science (SES) Annual Technical Meeting, West Lafayette, IN, Oct 11-14, 2026
- 2024 “Towards data-driven inverse design for materials and structures”
 National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), Thermodynamics and Kinetics Group

CAMPUS / DEPARTMENTAL TALKS

- 2023 “Towards data-driven inverse design for materials and structures,” seminar speaker, Virtual, iShare seminar series (UIUC, UIC, Duke), July 2023
- 2022 “Optimization of an optical shutter using machine learning,” Sandia Academic Alliance - University of Illinois LDRD Mini-Conference, Urbana, IL, Sept 2022.
- 2022 “Experiences / lessons learned from post-grad school industry life,” UIUC, DIGI-MAT Professional Development Seminar, July 2022
- 2021 “Rclone,” UIUC, DIGI-MAT Professional Development Seminar, July 2021

RESEARCH / CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Presentations Given

- 2026 **B. Jasperson**, D. Cao, P. Jain, J. Tan, W. Neiswanger, K. Garikipati, “On the accuracy and stability of spatiotemporal ViT solvers for mechanics,” 20th U.S. National Congress on Theoretical and Applied Mechanics (USNC-TAM26), Pasadena, CA, June 21-25, 2026 (Accepted talk)
- 2025 **B. Jasperson**, R. Gulati, Q. T. Tran, I. D. Boureima, H. Mourad, K. Garikipati, “Machine learning solvers for phase-field fracture mechanics,” Society of Engineering Science (SES) Annual Technical Meeting, Atlanta, GA, Oct 12-15, 2025
- 2025 **B. Jasperson**, Q. T. Tran, I. D. Boureima, H. Mourad, K. Garikipati, “A global-local approach to phase-field fracture mechanics using an integrated machine learning-PDE solver,” 18th U.S. National Congress on Computational Mechanics (USNCCM), Chicago, IL, July 20-24, 2025

- 2025 **B. Jasperson**, M. F. Shojaei, R. Gulati, S. Wang, S. Cimolato, D. Cao, W. Neiswanger, K. Garikipati, "Creating an AI Professor for a finite element methods course," Engineering Mechanics Institute Conference (EMI 2025), Anaheim, CA, May 27-30, 2025
- 2025 **B. Jasperson**, I. Nikiforov, A. Samanta, F. Zhou, B. Runnels, H. Johnson, V. Lordi, V. Bulatov, E. Tadmor, "Cross-scale covariance for material property prediction," Engineering Mechanics Institute Conference (EMI 2025), Anaheim, CA, May 27-30, 2025
- 2024 **B. Jasperson**, H. Johnson, "Towards data-driven inverse design for interatomic potentials," Engineering Mechanics Institute Conference and Probabilistic Mechanics & Reliability Conference (EMI/PMC 2024), Chicago, IL, May 27-30, 2024.
- 2023 **B. Jasperson**, H. Johnson, "Using data and machine learning to simplify and accelerate inverse design and model development in materials," poster, Society of Engineering Science (SES) Future Faculty Symposium, Minneapolis, MN, Oct 8-11, 2023.
- 2023 **B. Jasperson**, I. Nikiforov, H. Johnson, E. Tadmor, "Predicting grain boundary energy from few-atom simulations: A study across interatomic potentials," Society of Engineering Science (SES) Annual Technical Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, Oct 8-11, 2023.
- 2023 **B. Jasperson**, M. Wood, H. Johnson, "Inverse design and fabrication of a vanadium dioxide optical device using a dual neural network topology optimization approach," 17th U.S. National Congress on Computational Mechanics (USNCCM), Albuquerque, NM, July 23-27, 2023.
- 2022 **B. Jasperson**, M. Wood, H. Johnson, "Optimization of an optical shutter using machine learning," Society of Engineering Science (SES) Annual Technical Meeting, College Station, TX, Oct 16-19, 2022.
- 2022 **B. Jasperson**, "Optimization of an optical shutter using machine learning," Harnessing Data for Materials Symposium, Chicago, IL, Aug 19-30, 2022.
- 2010 **B. Jasperson**, F. Pfefferkorn, W. Qu, K. Turner, "A thin-film heat flux sensor fabricated on copper for heat transfer measurements in parallel channel heat sinks," 5th International Conference on Micromanufacturing (ICOMM), Madison, WI, April 5-8, 2010.

Coauthored Presentations (selected)

- 2025 E. Tadmor, **B. Jasperson**, I. Nikiforov, A. Samanta, F. Zhou, B. Runnels, H. Johnson, V. Lordi, V. Bulatov, "Cross-scale covariance for material property prediction," presented at APS Global Physics Summit, March 16-21, 2025.
- 2025 R. Gulati, **B. Jasperson**, K. Garikipati, "Transformer models in continuum mechanics," presented at SIAM Conference on Computational Science and Engineering, Fort Worth, TX, March 3-7, 2025
- 2009 B. Smith, **B. Jasperson**, and S. Manakasettharn, "Micro-machined molds for manufacturing micro-fluidic devices using soft lithography," poster, presented at International Manufacturing Science and Engineering Conference-MSEC, West Lafayette, IN, Oct 4-7, 2009.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025 - Guest Scientist - T-3 Division
Los Alamos National Laboratory (LANL)
- 2020 - 2024 Research Assistant, Prof. Harley Johnson's group
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL
- 2023 DIGI-MAT Graduate Internship, Prof. Ellad Tadmor's group
University of Minnesota Twin Cities, Minneapolis, MN
- 2021 - 2023 National Science Foundation (NSF) NRT Trainee
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL

2008 - 2010 Research Assistant, Prof. Frank Pfefferkorn's and Prof. Kevin Turner's groups
University of Wisconsin - Madison, Madison, WI

TEACHING AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

2026 Instructor, USNC/TAM26 Short Course, "Foundation Models in Mechanics," June 2026
(accepted course)

2026 Guest lecturer, Machine Learning and Computational Physics (AME 508),
University of Southern California

2025 Instructor, USNCCM Short Course, "Fine-tuning large language models for Computational
Mechanics," July 2025

2025 "Cross-scale covariance for material property prediction," MSE 598 guest lecturer,
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Spring 2025 ([link](#))

2024 - Mentor to multiple master's students, Prof. Krishna Garikipati's group,
University of Southern California

2023 Teaching Assistant, Introductory Solid Mechanics (TAM251),
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Fall 2023

2022 - 2023 Mentor, Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (URAP),
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2017 - 2020 "Project Planning for Engineers," ME 490 Senior Design guest lecturer,
Milwaukee School of Engineering

2016 - 2018 "Prototyping," ME Senior Design guest lecturer,
University of Wisconsin-Madison

2012 Mentor, FIRST Robotics, NEW Apple Corps - Team 93 (Appleton, WI)

2010 - 2020 Industry mentor for multiple interns and full-time hires

AWARDS, GRANTS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

2025 USNCCM18 Travel Award

2024 Top ten finalist, USNC/TAM 5MT Virtual Thesis Competition

2023 List of "Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students"
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Fall 2023

2023 Accepted to the Future Faculty Symposium
Society of Engineering Science, 2023

2023 Mavis Future Faculty Fellow (MF3)
University of Illinois Urbana - Champaign

2021 - 2023 NSF Graduate Traineeship
DIGI-MAT: Data and Informatics Graduate Intern-Traineeship: Materials at the Atomic Scale
University of Illinois Urbana - Champaign

2014 Article selected as "Highlights of 2014", *J. Micromech. Microeng.*

2008 Graduated with Distinction, University of Wisconsin, Madison

LICENSES AND CERTIFICATIONS

2024 Certificate in Foundations of Teaching
Center for Innovation in Teaching & Learning (CITL)
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2023 Graduate College Mentoring Certificate
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2016 - Professional Engineer (P.E.), State of Wisconsin (Credential/License #45161)

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026 Session co-chair and organizer, “Foundation models for mechanics” Minisymposium, 20th U.S. National Congress of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics, Pasadena, CA, June 21-25, 2026 (accepted)

2025 - Journal Reviewer: Journal of Nonlinear Science

2024 Volunteer Judge, Undergraduate Research Symposium
University of Illinois Urbana - Champaign

2021 - 2022 Students Advising on Graduate Education (SAGE)
University of Illinois Urbana - Champaign

2021 - USACM - Member

2019 - ASME - Member

2005 - Tau Beta Pi – Wisconsin Alpha Chapter, Illinois Alpha Chapter

Last updated on Jun 4, 2026